

Coniferous plants

Since conifers stay green all year, little sunlight reaches the forest floor. Also, conifer needles are acidic, like the juice of a lemon. When they break down they make the soil acidic too. The lack of light and acidic soil mean fewer plants grow here than elsewhere, but there are still many to spot.

Berry bearers

Scrambling plants, such as the blackberry, thrive in conifer forests. Their thorny vines allow them to climb up and over other plants toward the light, and the berries they produce provide food for animals and birds.

Blackberries make a tasty snack for foxes and deer.

Ferns

Ferns are flowerless plants, many of which love moist, shady conditions. This deer fern won't grow taller than 20 in (50 cm), but the giant chain fern, which grows underneath redwood trees, can be nearly 6.5 ft (2 m) tall!

